

pre-requisites:

desgd 145
or despx 115
or instructor
permission

DESPX 260
section 004

Winter 2024
Tu 5:00p-7:50p
Th 5:00p-7:50p
2318 WCCB

DESGD 260
section 004

Nora Hudgens
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Office hours:
by appointment

course purpose

Students will help encourage human flourishing and charitable human interactions through mastering the process of creating user experience design and crafting engaging user interfaces.

course description

In this course,¹ students will explore the process for developing digital products that serve users’ needs. Students will prototype screen-based experiences that are empathetic to the needs of the end user. Students will develop design concepts that mediate relationships between people and products, environments, and services.

This is a project-based graphic design studio course with a balanced mix of technical instruction and critique. In this class you will think broadly about designing for different media and how designs change in response to time, space, interactions. In sum, you will learn to design experiences, not just visuals.

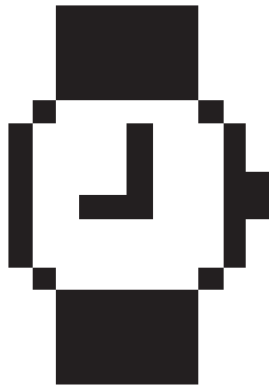
technical skill & concepts²

You will learn to improve and assist your design skills using industry-standard software tools. You can certainly be a good designer and not know how to use design software, but you will be empowered to do more in your career and be more independent if you know the tools.

Although part of the class will teach technical skills, the goal is to create designed products and visuals with strong concepts and ideas, rooted in excellent typography. You can manipulate photos, or vectors, or illustrate like a pro, but you will never be a good designer until you learn how to use type, work conceptually, and think systematically.

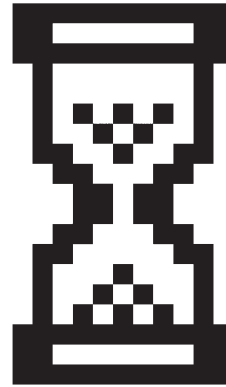
1. Thank you. 260 was envisioned collaboratively between Douglas Thomas, Brian Collier, and Nora Hudgens. It is built on previous UX- and UX-related courses taught at BYU. Portions of exercises, projects, and grading rubric adapted from courses at Maryland Institute College of Art, including two projects from the Design for User Experience course: Andrew Morgan (Spring 2016); Douglas Thomas (Summer 2016); and Jarrett Fuller (Fall 2016); further changes and adaptations by Douglas Thomas at Brigham Young University for DESGD 360: Interaction Design I (Winter and Fall 2017, Winter 2018, 2019, 2020, and 2021). And thanks to other DESGD 360 teachers who have been in conversation with the material and continued development of DESGD 360 (2018–2024): Gavin Jensen, Aaron Shurtleff, and Laura Barlow Leavitt, Brian Collier, and Alan Wilson.

2. This section adapts and quotes directly from my colleague Brent Barson’s DESGD 280 Media Design syllabus (2018). Used with permission. The interaction portions of DESGD 280 Media Design was a predecessor to this class. The motion portion of that class has grown into DES 280 Motion Concepts.



Watch icon, used to represent the computer "waiting" or "thinking" in Apple Macintosh OS 1

Susan Kare, 1984



Hourglass icon, represent the computer "waiting" or "thinking" in Microsoft Windows 3.0

Susan Kare, 1990

learning outcomes

better interactions & experiences

Students will be able to discuss critically and effectively design products and experiences that encourage human flourishing and charitable interactions.

critical analysis of form and format

Students will be able to identify and critically discuss the affordances and constraints of different forms and formats of interactive media, demonstrating how they affect understanding and demand attention in all contexts, from consumer applications as well as faith and devotion.

problem discovery & research (curiosity, empathy, humility)

Students will demonstrate discovery of design problems (challenges) to be solved through developing attributes of curiosity, empathy, and humility. They will demonstrate their learning through appropriate use of research methods, including qualitative and quantitative data collection, ethnography, empathy-building, and usability testing.

familiarity and distinctiveness

Students will be able to create designs that appropriately balance familiar patterns and distinctive elements, creating products that show an understanding of long-standing mental models, platform-specific defaults and standards, as well as unique branding, typography, and interface styles within current design sensibilities.

design strategy

Students will contextualize their visual design solutions into strategic frameworks, packaging design decisions within an understanding of the competitive landscape and creation of a distinctive brand.

communication and feedback

Students will be able to defend and explain their design decisions, communicate clearly, and give and receive constructive feedback through a variety of reviews including usability testing, team and peer critique, and design reviews with faculty.

detailed documentation

Students will be able to create detailed documentation of their design process and final design outcome, with clear written explanations of interface content and functionality.

assignments & schedule

class grouping

major assigninment

subset assignments

9 January–
23 January
(Project A due)
2 weeks

A. Start Here →
*Journeys, Destinations,
Touchpoints*

**Wayfinding Map
+ Icon Set**
10% of Grade

A1. Wayfinding Map Sketch
A2. Icon Set Sketch
A3. Vectorized Icon Set
A4. Final Icon Set + Map

23 January–
6 February
(Project B due)
2 weeks

B. One More Thing →
*Product Design as Discovery and
Problem Solving; Conventions*

**Make it Better
App**
10% of Grade

B1. Visual User Flow &
Competitive Analysis
B2. User Diagram
B3. Usability Tests
B4. Final Make it Better

6 February–
15 February
(Project C due)
2 weeks

C. Hello, World! →
*Responsive, Online,
and Mobile Design*

**Hierarchy/
Responsive Web**
10% of Grade

C1. Digital Hierarchy
C2. Type Exploration
C3. Responsive Grid
C4. Responsive Final

22 February–
4 April
(Project D due)
7 weeks

D. Inform & Delight →
*Problem Seeking, Product
as Beautiful and Functional
Interfaces*

Neue App
40% of Grade

D1. Ideation/Validation
D2. Observ. Storyboard &
Emotional Journey Map
D3. Research/Persona
D4. Competitive Analysis
D5. Paper Prototype
D6. Usability Tests #1
D7. Wireframe
D8. Digital Prototype
D9. Usability Tests #2
D10. Brand, Type, Icons
D11. High Fidelity Mock
D12. Neue App Draft 2
D13. Final Neue App

4 April–
24 April
(Project E due)
all throughout,
concentrated in
the final 2 weeks

E. Thinking Made Visible→
*Storytelling of thoughts; Documentation,
Case Studies, Finesse of final project*

**Hierarchy/
Responsive Web**
9% of Grade

E. Final Documentation

all throughout

X. Exercises + Participation
These are largely related to writing, analysis, thinking
about the interconnection of ideas throughout the course.
Other smaller exercises will be parts of the larger projects.

9% of Grade

X1. Letter to Faculty
X2–X6 Reading Response

due by
18 April

Y. Course Evaluation

1% of Grade

deliverables and work

deliverables

UX deliverables are not just interfaces. Often, the best way to sell an idea is through careful, intelligent documentation. You will be asked to document all stages of your work, including visual research, writing, sketches, revisions and final deliverables. Research can be gathered in any fashion, however it must be conducive to digital submission, so you should be able to photograph, scan or otherwise convert your research into digital assets. Each assignment will be graded on your documentation as well as your final product. At the end of each project, final documentation of the project's research, design and development will be submitted for grading and records purposes. Specific guidelines for this will be discussed in class for each project.

grade scale

A (100–94); A- (93–90); B+ (89–87); B (86–83); B- (82–80); C+ (79–77); C (76–73); D+ (69–67); D (66–63); D- (62–60); E (60 and below)

project grades

See rubric pages

turning in projects

All major projects will be turned in via Learning Suite. Some class exercises and intermediate assignments will be completed and turned online using collaborative software: GoogleDocs, Dropbox Paper documents, Figma files, Miro boards, and/or Lucid charts. *If you ever have technical issues turning in a project via Learning Suite, please send me the project via email.*

Final projects should be turned as non-cloud documents (PDFs, MP4s, Keynote presentations, and Word documents).

back up your work+

Project backups are required for all digital projects. I suggest using a cloud based system such as Dropbox or Google Drive and also a physical harddrive backup like a thumbdrive.

late work

Projects that are turned in on time may be resubmitted for re-evaluation at the end of the semester. However, late work will be lowered by a full letter grade each day it is late. Late work will not be tolerated, unless notice is given 2 days prior to the deadline. This policy is designed to incentivize you into letting go of your project and moving on to the next project so that you can get a grade and feedback on a project, and if you wish, rework projects for a better grade.

materials

Sketchbook, Pencil/pen/eraser

Computer (Mac preferred, not required.

In general, you'll want at least a multicore Intel Processor with 64-bit support, 8GB RAM, 5 GB of available hard-disk space, additional space required for initial installation, 10 GB + for disk cache, 1280x1080 display; any M1 chip MacBook should be able to handle the work).

Adobe creative cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator, Acrobat, After Effects)

Figma (for UX projects)



+This is for everyone, not just those using a lab computer. Please, please, please, do yourself a favor and make sure you have a backup solution in place for this and all of your other design classes. There is nothing more devastating than losing your work because of disk failure or other complications. Don't assume it won't happen to you!

3. Adapted from Professor
Douglas Thomas, BYU

overarching goal³

My first concern is your well-being and success as a person. I hope this class and the design program overall is instrumental toward that end. Your performance in this class is not my only goal. Your success as a whole person is the goal, with your success in this class a supporting goal. I value your personal health (physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual) as well as your needs (and duties) in other areas of life: family, friends, and work. I believe that your success in this class should help you succeed in other areas, and as such want you to work hard, grow, and develop new talents and skills.

engagement⁴

You are expected to actively and passionately take part in this course. Your engagement will affect your final grade (mostly because it is integrally wrapped up in the quality of your work). Your engagement includes:

- Attending class meetings on time both in person and online.
- Create things and be prepared to show them on time for crits and discussions.
- Make things thoughtfully, intentionally, and with intensity.
- Meet all deadlines for handing in work and process (see professionalism & illness section).
- Actively participate in critiques and discussion both in person and online.
- Be actively curious about making things and the things your classmates make.
- Care about yourself and your work, your classmates and their work, this class, and your profession.

attention

Technology is an essential part of this class. But when used inappropriately, can hinder learning. Attention to the discussion, to each other, and to your work is the greatest gift you can give your education in this class and to each other. You have all sat next to others who use their devices in class to check e-mail, message, search the Internet, or play games. Unfortunately, every person sitting around such students is distracted by this behavior. More crucially, your absence from the discussion creates a void. This is especially true through a live video delivery of the class (Zoom).

Dividing your attention (and that of your fellow students) can also be the greatest enemy to your learning.

4. Adapted from Professor
Mitch Goldstein, RIT
Graphic Design Dept.

course delivery

The course schedule, assignments, and readings will be available on dropbox paper. Please check it frequently for course access. Only grades will be on learning suite.

All class sessions will be conducted in person by default. However, if necessary, some classes will be remote sessions via zoom (either for illness, changing campus circumstances, or travel). If the default class delivery needs to change, you will be notified via email. If you are sick, please stay home; if your symptoms allow you to attend remotely, I can provide a zoom link so that you can quarantine and still participate.⁵

You are expected to attend class, unless circumstances, such as health problems or caregiving responsibilities, make that impossible. Participation is integral to the success of this class—and many assignments will be completed during class.

professionalism & illness

I am willing to work with you if you cannot attend class or need flexibility with due dates for sickness or other reasonable circumstances. In return, I expect professional communication from you. Long-standing family trips, weddings, vacations, and job interviews are not emergencies. Please communicate. Plan ahead. In a word, I expect the same level of professionalism you'd show to a job or even the simple respect you'd show a friend. Let me know if you can't make it.

Please stay home if you are sick. If you become ill or find yourself having to care for someone else who is ill, please let me know as soon as you can. I will not ask for documentation, but I do need to know if I need to make appropriate, mutually acceptable accommodations.

If you are ill with COVID-19, you should immediately report this to the university at: <https://www.byu.edu/coronavirus/>. This site is not a substitute for communication with me or other professors, however. I trust you as students, and I ask that we all act with utmost honesty and integrity—particularly during pandemic-affected semesters (COVID is still happening in 2024).

Sometimes I have encountered students who stay home because they are afraid of showing incomplete or imperfect work. If you don't feel ready to show work, I would rather have you come to class without your work than not come to class because you don't have it done. We need you.

5. In general, I will not automatically make recordings of classes unless specifically requested as an accommodation for illness or other needs. For recorded classes, recordings of group lectures/discussions will be made available within a day or two of the original lecture for review. Critique sessions will not be recorded.

children in class⁵

As part of my commitment to helping all students succeed, children are welcome in my class within the following guidelines:

1. All breastfeeding babies are welcome in class as often as necessary (for Moms or Dads).
2. Non-nursing babies and older children are welcome whenever alternate arrangements cannot be made. As a parent of young children, I understand that child care falls through, partners have conflicting schedules, and other issues arise that leave parents with few options.
3. In all cases when children come to class, I invite parents/caregivers to sit close to the door so as to more easily excuse yourself to attend to your child's needs. Non-parents in class: please reserve seats near the door for your parenting classmates.
4. All students are expected to join with me in creating a welcoming environment that is respectful of your classmates who bring children to class.
5. Finally, I understand that among the most difficult aspects of parenting young children is sleep deprivation and exhaustion.

The struggles of balancing school, work, childcare, and other day-to-day activities is tiring, and I will do my best to accommodate any such issues while maintaining the same high expectations for all students enrolled in the class.

Please contact me if you have questions.

mental health

Mental health concerns and stressful life events can affect students' academic performance and quality of life. BYU Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS, 1500 WSC, 801-422-3035, caps.byu.edu) provides individual, couples, and group counseling, as well as stress management services.

These services are confidential and are provided by the university at no cost for full-time students. For general information please visit <https://caps.byu.edu>; for more immediate concerns please visit <http://help.byu.edu>.

honor code

In keeping with the principles of the BYU Honor Code, students are expected to be honest in all of their academic work. Academic honesty means, most fundamentally, that any work you present as your own must in fact be your own work and not that of another. Violations of this principle may result in a failing grade in the course and additional disciplinary action by the university. Students are also expected to adhere to the Dress and Grooming Standards. Adherence demonstrates respect for yourself and others and ensures an effective learning and working

environment. It is the university's expectation, and every instructor's expectation in class, that each student will abide by all Honor Code standards. Please call the Honor Code Office at 801-422-2847 if you have questions about those standards.

artificial intelligence & academic honesty

Generative AI tools may be used in this class with attribution (unless specifically prohibited for particular assignments).

BYU's academic honesty policy states, in part, "students should seek to be totally honest in their dealings with others. They should complete their own work and be evaluated based upon that work."

The primary work of this class is to produce your final portfolio, and to polish your portfolio projects in preparation for graduation and post-graduate academic and employment work. Future employers and graduate programs want to know what was your work, and what was the work you art directed (including illustration, photography, or generative AI).

Do not outsource your creative thinking and critical questioning to artificial intelligence.

At the same time, Generative AI is and can be a useful tool to dramatically speed up exploration, idea formation, structural approaches to writing, rewriting, and of course, grammar, clarity of speech, as well as a tool for digital art creation.

plagiarism

Intentional plagiarism is a form of intellectual theft that violates widely recognized principles of academic integrity as well as the Honor Code. Such plagiarism may subject the student to appropriate disciplinary action administered through the university Honor Code Office, in addition to academic sanctions that may be applied by an instructor. Inadvertent plagiarism, which may not be a violation of the Honor Code, is nevertheless a form of intellectual carelessness that is unacceptable in the academic community.

Plagiarism of any kind is completely contrary to the established practices of higher education where all members of the university are expected to acknowledge the original intellectual work of others that is included in their own work. In some cases, plagiarism may also involve violations of copyright law.

Intentional Plagiarism is the deliberate act of representing the words, ideas, or data of another as one's own without providing proper attribution to the author through quotation, reference, or footnote. Inadvertent Plagiarism

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Besides being a quick way to fail my class, remember that intentional plagiarising is really just robbing yourself of the learning experience.

We'll talk about how to appropriately integrate others' designs into your work. While plagiarism is the bad extreme on one end of the spectrum, it is also folly to attempt original work without reference to others' design work.

involves the inappropriate, but non-deliberate, use of another's words, ideas, or data without proper attribution. Inadvertent plagiarism usually results from an ignorant failure to follow established rules for documenting sources or from simply not being sufficiently careful in research and writing.

Although not a violation of the Honor Code, inadvertent plagiarism is a form of academic misconduct for which an instructor can impose appropriate academic sanctions. Students who are in doubt as to whether they are providing proper attribution have the responsibility to consult with their instructor and obtain guidance.

preventing & responding to sexual misconduct

In accordance with Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, Brigham Young University prohibits unlawful sex discrimination against any participant in its education programs or activities. The university also prohibits sexual harassment-including sexual violence-committed by or against students, university employees, and visitors to campus. As outlined in university policy, sexual harassment, dating violence, domestic violence, sexual assault, and stalking are considered forms of "Sexual Misconduct" prohibited by the university.

University policy requires all university employees in a teaching, managerial, or supervisory role to report all incidents of Sexual Misconduct that come to their attention in any way, including but not limited to face-to-face conversations, a written class assignment or paper, class discussion, email, text, or social media post. Incidents of Sexual Misconduct should be reported to the Title IX Coordinator at t9coordinator@byu.edu or 801-422-8692. Reports may also be submitted through EthicsPoint at <https://titleix.byu.edu/report> or 1-888-238-1062 (24-hours a day).

BYU offers confidential resources for those affected by Sexual Misconduct, including the university's Victim Advocate, as well as a number of non-confidential resources and services that may be helpful. Additional information about Title IX, the university's Sexual Misconduct Policy, reporting requirements, and resources can be found at <http://titleix.byu.edu> or by contacting the university's Title IX Coordinator.

students with disabilities

Brigham Young University is committed to providing a working and learning atmosphere that reasonably accommodates qualified persons with disabilities. If you have any disability which may impair your ability to complete this course successfully, please contact the University Accessibility Center (UAC), 2170 WSC or 801-422-2767.

Reasonable academic accommodations are reviewed for all students who have qualified, documented disabilities. The UAC can also assess students for learning, attention, and emotional concerns. Services are coordinated with the student and instructor by the UAC. If you need assistance or if you feel you have been unlawfully discriminated against on the basis of disability, you may seek resolution through established grievance policy and procedures by contacting the Equal Employment Office at 422-5895, D-285 ASB.

QR Code for 260 Class Dropbox Paper Page



<https://paper.dropbox.com/doc/DESGD-DESPX-260--CHRB7fd1wghYY1o5o6pclB9IAQ-d8ScFLyX3OQLnjDJEeBpR>

This class uses Dropbox paper for all day-to-day information. It will use Learning Suite for grades and to email out announcements.